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CHAPTER 2

Expansion of British Power in India (Part 4)

Conquest of Sindh and Punjab

Introduction

After defeating the Marathas, the British focused on **Sindh** and **Punjab** to strengthen their control over north-western India.

Sindh was annexed in **1843**, while Punjab became part of the British Empire after the **Second Anglo-Sikh War** in **1849**. These topics are frequently asked in Punjab Police, PSSSB, PCS and SSC examinations.

Conquest of Sindh

What was it?

The British occupied Sindh to secure India's north-western frontier and stop possible foreign threats.

Important Exam Facts

- Lord **Minto** sent **Nicholas Smith** to Sindh to negotiate with the **Amirs of Sindh**.
- The **Treaty of Eternal Friendship** was the first treaty between the British and the Amirs.
- During the **First Anglo-Afghan War**, British troops passed through Sindh.
- A succession dispute among the Amirs gave the British an opportunity to interfere.
- The Amirs revolted but were defeated.
- In **1843**, **Lord Ellenborough** annexed Sindh.
- **Charles Napier** became the first British Governor of Sindh.

Conquest of Punjab

What was it?

Punjab was the last major independent kingdom conquered by the British in northern India.

Important Exam Facts

- In **1809**, the **Treaty of Amritsar** was signed between **Maharaja Ranjit Singh** and the East India Company.
- Under this treaty, the **River Sutlej** became the boundary between Punjab and the British territories.
- In **1838**, Ranjit Singh signed the **Tripartite Treaty** with the British and **Shah Shuja**.
- After the death of **Ranjit Singh (1839)**, Punjab faced political instability.
- Frequent changes of rulers and court conspiracies weakened the Sikh Empire.
- **Lal Singh** became Wazir and **Teja Singh** became Commander of the Sikh army before the First Anglo-Sikh War.

First Anglo-Sikh War (1845–46)

What was it?

This was the first military conflict between the British and the Sikh Empire.

Important Exam Facts

- The war began after the Sikh army crossed the **River Sutlej**.
- The Sikh army was led by **Lal Singh**.
- The British won successive battles at:
 - **Mudki**
 - **Ferozeshah**
 - **Buddelwal**
 - **Aliwal**
 - **Sabraon**
- The defeats were mainly due to the betrayal of **Lal Singh** and **Teja Singh**.

Treaty of Lahore (1846)

What was it?

The Treaty of Lahore was signed after the British victory in the First Anglo-Sikh War.

Important Exam Facts

- Signed on **9 March 1846**.
- Sikhs had to pay a **war indemnity of more than one crore rupees**.
- **Jalandhar Doab** was annexed by the British.
- A **British Resident** was appointed at Lahore under **Henry Lawrence**.
- **Daleep Singh** was recognised as Maharaja under **Rani Jindan** as Regent.
- As the indemnity could not be fully paid, **Kashmir including Jammu** was transferred to **Gulab Singh**.

Treaty of Bhairawal (1846)

What was it?

The British further increased their control over Punjab through this treaty.

Important Exam Facts

- Signed in **December 1846**.
- **Rani Jindan** was removed as Regent.
- A **Council of Regency** was formed.
- The Council worked under the British Resident **Henry Lawrence**.

Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848–49)

What was it?

This war ended the independent Sikh Empire.

Important Exam Facts

- The revolt began at **Multan** under **Mulraj**.
- **Sher Singh** later joined the revolt.
- **Lord Dalhousie** personally supervised the campaign.
- Three important battles were fought:
 - **Ramnagar**
 - **Chillianwala**
 - **Gujarat**
- After the **Battle of Gujarat**, the Sikh army surrendered.

- Punjab was annexed by the British in **March 1849**.
- A **three-member Board** consisting of **Henry Lawrence, John Lawrence and Charles Mansel** governed Punjab.
- In **1853**, the Board was abolished and **John Lawrence** became the first Chief Commissioner of Punjab.

Important Personalities

Personality	Importance
Lord Minto	Sent diplomatic mission to Sindh.
Nicholas Smith	Negotiated with the Amirs of Sindh.
Lord Ellenborough	Annexed Sindh in 1843.
Charles Napier	First British Governor of Sindh.
Maharaja Ranjit Singh	Founder of the Sikh Empire.
Shah Shuja	Party to the Tripartite Treaty.
Lal Singh	Wazir during the First Anglo-Sikh War.
Teja Singh	Commander of the Sikh army.
Henry Lawrence	British Resident at Lahore.
Rani Jindan	Regent for Daleep Singh.
Daleep Singh	Last Maharaja of the Sikh Empire.
Mulraj	Revolt at Multan.
Sher Singh	Joined the Multan revolt.
Lord Dalhousie	Annexed Punjab after the Second Anglo-Sikh War.
John Lawrence	First Chief Commissioner of Punjab.

Important Places

Place	Importance
Sindh	Annexed in 1843.
Lahore	Treaty of Lahore signed.
Amritsar	Treaty of Amritsar signed.
River Sutlej	Boundary fixed under the Treaty of Amritsar.
Jalandhar Doab	Annexed under the Treaty of Lahore.
Multan	Revolt that led to the Second Anglo-Sikh War.
Ramnagar	Battle of Second Anglo-Sikh War.
Chillianwala	Battle of Second Anglo-Sikh War.
Gujarat	Final decisive battle of the Second Anglo-Sikh War.

Important Wars / Treaties

Name	Importance
Treaty of Eternal Friendship	First treaty between the British and the Amirs of Sindh.
Treaty of Amritsar	Fixed the Sutlej as the boundary.
Tripartite Treaty	Agreement between Ranjit Singh, the British and Shah Shuja.
First Anglo-Sikh War	Led to the Treaty of Lahore.
Treaty of Lahore	Reduced Sikh independence.
Treaty of Bhairowal	Increased British control over Punjab.
Second Anglo-Sikh War	Resulted in the annexation of Punjab.

Important Years

Year	Event
1809	Treaty of Amritsar.
1838	Tripartite Treaty.
1843	Annexation of Sindh.
1845–46	First Anglo-Sikh War.
1846	Treaties of Lahore and Bhairowal.
1848–49	Second Anglo-Sikh War.
1849	Annexation of Punjab.
1853	John Lawrence became First Chief Commissioner.

Frequently Confused Facts

Question	Correct Answer
Governor-General who annexed Sindh	Lord Ellenborough
First British Governor of Sindh	Charles Napier
Treaty fixing the Sutlej boundary	Treaty of Amritsar
Last Maharaja of the Sikh Empire	Daleep Singh
British Resident at Lahore	Henry Lawrence
Regent of Daleep Singh	Rani Jindan
Final battle of the Second Anglo-Sikh War	Battle of Gujarat
First Chief Commissioner of Punjab	John Lawrence

Previous Year Exam Focus

- Treaty of Amritsar.

- River Sutlej.
- Tripartite Treaty.
- Lord Ellenborough.
- Charles Napier.
- First Anglo-Sikh War.
- Treaty of Lahore.
- Treaty of Bhairawal.
- Henry Lawrence.
- Rani Jindan.
- Daleep Singh.
- Second Anglo-Sikh War.
- Battle of Gujarat.
- Annexation of Punjab.
- John Lawrence.

Expected MCQ Areas

- Conquest of Sindh.
- Treaty of Eternal Friendship.
- Treaty of Amritsar.
- Anglo-Sikh Wars.
- Treaty of Lahore.
- Treaty of Bhairawal.
- Henry Lawrence.
- Battle of Gujarat.
- Annexation of Punjab.
- John Lawrence.

Memory Tricks

- **Ellenborough = Entered Sindh**

- **Amritsar = Sutlej Boundary**
- **Lahore = Loss for Sikhs**
- **Bhairowal = British Control**
- **Gujarat = Game Over for Sikh Empire**

Quick Revision (2 Minutes)

- Sindh
- Amirs
- Nicholas Smith
- Eternal Friendship
- Ellenborough
- Charles Napier
- Ranjit Singh
- Amritsar Treaty
- Sutlej
- Tripartite Treaty
- Lal Singh
- Teja Singh
- Lahore Treaty
- Bhairowal
- Henry Lawrence
- Rani Jindan
- Daleep Singh
- Multan
- Gujarat
- John Lawrence
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